

a light blue, a sunny day is yellow, a very hot day is orangy-red, etc. When such calm technology is put in place, eventually, we just adapt to it, and it doesn't have a distracting voice yelling out the temperature to you, it doesn't involve you looking at a screen... there's nothing but a peripheral / background colour that intuitively tells you something you need to know. Extrapolate this for everything else, and you realise where she is pointing us to, and I don't know about you, but I very much want to go on a calm tech journey with her!

Golden Krishna

Currently working on Android design strategy at Google, Golden has worked in the R&D field for Google, Samsung and Zappos. Golden is perhaps not as well known by the general public as



Golden thinks the best UI is #NoUI

the other people on this list, but we expect that to change. Around 2012 Golden wrote a blog post called "The best interface is no interface", and it started getting shared around a lot. Eventually he wrote a book about the topic and then started giving talks about it as well.

Essentially, like Amber, Golden also believes that screens are invading every aspect of our lives when they perhaps shouldn't be. In his talks he targets cars, and the touch screen interfaces that they come with, because unless we get fully automated, self-driving cars, we all know for a fact that anything in a car that visually distracts a driver from looking at the road is just a bad, and dangerous design.

It certainly doesn't help that some companies went ga-ga over integrating Twitter and Facebook feeds into the dashboard of the cars!

However, that's not all, he also criticised the idea of using phone apps to unlock your car, when there already were solutions that allowed you to keep your keys in your pocket and unlock your car door just by pulling on the handle. Proximity sensors just work, and why on earth would you want to replace something that just works perfectly with a screen that actually makes the whole process far more complex?

Of course Golden is not advocating doing away with screens... he does work on Android after all, so it's not like he can claim to be doing away with all visual interfaces... However, it looks like Google is certainly open to reducing screen clutter and finding new ways in which to imagine phones and gadgets, which is always a good thing.

OTHER IDEAS

A lot of the ideas we could list under here have been listed in the stories before this one already. For example, Moon Ribas using sound and vibration to inform her of movement and earthquakes, could very well be used in other ways as well.

The simple electric kettle so many of us use to boil water with, is an example of a one task device that has perfected its UI, and is essentially invisible. No good would ever come out of adding a voice to the kettle, or having it beep when its got less water in it, or too much water, or anything along those lines.

The problem is, convergence means that we all want to carry fewer devices, and yet have much, much more functionality than before. This usually is why we end up with desktops in our pockets. There is however the buzzword of 2018 that we've left for the last, and with good reason.

AI (artificial, not augmented) is how a lot of people (including Google's CEO, Sunder Pichai) see us just getting rid of the devices altogether.

Instead of a smart fridge that talks to you, an AI service might let us leave food stock management to a machine

in the cloud that's whirring away and being your personal shopper. We never thought we'd ever be able to sit in a car without a driver, and yet that reality is fast approaching for most of the developed countries.

If we head towards a more cyborg-like future, where it's normal to get implants, we are definitely going to need a complete rethink of interfaces. Let's start with simple ones, such as earphones. They could be implants or discrete things we wear that use bone conduction. Maybe they can be partially implanted and connected to our bone, and also have a magnet, which allows you to click on an audio interface to start listening. We've already got wireless earphones, so there's no reason we shouldn't expect them to get smaller and more invisible. You could just be snapping on tiny battery packs to keep your implanted earphones powered up persistently.

With smarter devices (even without actual AI), there is a lot of functionality that could be done away with from your phone. You don't actually need a phone as large as the one you have... they're that large because of the large screen that we all want in order to watch videos, cyber stalk pictures of our love interests on Facebook, or use to chat or browse the web. If all they had to do was make phone calls, they could be made to be another simple implant... think phones implanted in hands, as shown in the 2012 remake of *Total Recall*. The biohacking and bodyhacking scene is already hard at work trying to make that a reality. We're pretty sure our kids or grand-kids (depending on how old you are now) will be getting such implants and be proper cyborgs.

We certainly don't think the human race is ready to do away with screens just yet, and so we're not predicting the death of the visual interface, but we are saying the total monopoly it has will end, as we discover newer and better ways to interface with technology. A true brain-computer interface (BCI), such as the Neural Net that would directly communicate with the internet, coupled with a cyborg trend might actually make not just our screens, but also our bodies obsolete! 